



**THE
KEYS
COACH**



FREE PDF GUIDE

PLAY LIKE FREDDIE MERCURY

4 Signature Moves

THEKEYSCOACH.COM

How To Play Like Freddie Mercury

Four Mercury Moves to Steal at the Piano



Introduction *from Adam*

Freddie Mercury's piano playing is simple, powerful, and full of clever detail. Here are a few signature ideas from his live playing to help you bring some of that drive, colour, and energy into your own playing.

Artist profile:

Freddie Mercury



Freddie Mercury is a legendary singer, songwriter, and pianist whose playing helped shape some of **Queen's** most iconic songs.

His piano style is bold, rhythmic, and full of **subtle detail**. Blending rock, ballad, and **theatrical playing**, his sound is simple on the surface but always powerful and distinctive. His piano parts helped define a huge part of Queen's sound.

Watch the Freddie Mercury performances that inspired the examples in this guide:

- [Bohemian Rhapsody \(Live @ Live Aid\)](#)
- [Somebody To Love](#)
- [Killer Queen](#)
- [Don't Stop Me Now](#)

Concept #1 (as seen in “Bohemian Rhapsody”)

Crossing Over

Try crossing your left hand over the right like Freddie on his live performance of **Bohemian Rhapsody** — it’s a classical technique that gives the line a **smooth**, elegant feel.

Crossover!

Add passing notes for extra momentum. Then bring in octaves on the crossover to make it sound **bigger** and more **dramatic**.

Octaves!

Passing notes!

Concept #2 (in “Somebody To Love”)

Driving Octaves

Using left-hand octaves is a great way to build **drive and intensity**, giving the part a stronger pulse and a bigger sound.



“This is the easiest way to build drama and tension!”

Ab Eb/G Fm⁷ Db Eb(sus⁴) Eb

Octaves!

Concept #3 (in “Killer Queen”)

Woodchop

The wood chop is a rhythmic idea where you play **short, percussive stabs** on the downbeats. It gives the groove a strong pulse and helps the part feel more driving and rhythmic.

Stab!

Cm Bb⁷

Concept #4 (in “Don’t Stop Me Now”)

Walkup

Build the bass line upward with **left-hand double octaves**, then **push** into the last chord to create momentum and lift.

Musical notation for the Walkup exercise. The bass line is shown in the left hand, starting on G2 and moving upward in double octaves (G2, G3, G4, G5, G6, G7). The right hand is shown in the right hand, starting on G4 and moving upward in double octaves (G4, G5, G6, G7, G8, G9). The final chord is C9(SUS4), which is highlighted with a dashed orange box and a green arrow pointing to it with the text "Push!".

Harmonise the walking bass line, then use a **diminished passing chord** to make the climb sound smoother and more crunchy!

Musical notation for the harmonized walkup exercise. The bass line is shown in the left hand, starting on G2 and moving upward in double octaves (G2, G3, G4, G5, G6, G7). The right hand is shown in the right hand, starting on G4 and moving upward in double octaves (G4, G5, G6, G7, G8, G9). The final chord is C9(SUS4), which is highlighted with a dashed orange box and a green arrow pointing to it with the text "Push!".



“Try it with your own bass line ideas and see how much momentum you can create!”